

The Prompt Library.

50 prompts you can use on Monday morning.
Built for the room. Written for real work.

GENAI EXCELLENCE · HYDERABAD

50
prompts

7
functions

10
rescue lines

0
gimmicks

How to use this book

Nothing in here is meant to be read cover to cover. It's a toolbox. Find the moment you're actually in, copy the prompt, replace the **[BRACKETS]** with your real details, and send it. Then improve it once — that second instruction is where all the quality lives.

THE ONE SHIFT

**Stop asking the AI a question.
Start giving it a briefing.**

Who you are. What's going on. What a good result looks like. Brief it like you'd brief a sharp new colleague — don't type at it like it's a search box.

THE RECIPE • C•T•P•F

Context — the situation and the real, specific details. Not "a delivery is late", but "PO-4471, the seals, the line is waiting, the customer already chased once." Vague in, vague out.

Tone — say it out loud, don't make it guess. "Firm but respectful." "Warm and apologetic." "Neutral and technical." The same facts written firm versus warm are two completely different emails.

Persona — who the AI is, and who it's writing to. "You are a senior procurement lead writing to a supplier we've worked with for ten years." One line, and it stops sounding like a call-centre script.

Format — the shape you want the answer in. An email. Three bullets. A table. A WhatsApp message under fifty words. If you don't say the shape, you get whatever shape it feels like — usually too long.

Can These Prompts Fly? — Context, Tone, Persona, Format. When an answer disappoints you, don't get frustrated and don't give up. Just ask: *which of these four did I leave out?* Add it. Run it again. That is the entire troubleshooting method for this technology.

Three rules and one hard line

Direction beats questions	"Draft a firm-but-warm reminder to a supplier a week late on PO-4471" gets you gold. "Write an email" gets you the dead one.
Examples beat adjectives	Don't argue about tone. Paste in one message you liked and say "this style, this length." Show, don't describe.
Iteration is the job	The first draft is clay. "Shorter. Firmer. Add the PO number. Lose the last line." Thirty seconds of nudging is where the quality lives. People who give up after one bad draft quit at the exact moment the value starts.

THE HARD LINE — DATA

Synthetic or masked data only, always.

No real customer names. No salary figures. No live financials. Build and test your prompts on fake data that has the same *shape* as the real thing — then apply the technique to real data only inside approved systems, on your company account. If you catch yourself about to paste something real: stop, mask it first.

AND ONE THING THAT IS ALWAYS TRUE

You sign off. Not the AI. It is a very fast, very tireless intern that will occasionally be confidently wrong — so every prompt in this book is built with a rail in it: **cite the row, flag it don't fix it, write [confirm] rather than invent**. Keep those rails in when you adapt them. That habit is what makes this safe to use for real.

Contents

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+ The ten follow-ups that fix almost anything	
+ Guardrail lines — copy, paste, stay safe	
+ Blank library card · add your own	
+ Your 30-day plan	
+ The master prompt — generate a library like this one	

Every prompt is copy-paste ready. Square brackets are yours to fill.

Everyday writing

The messages you write before your first chai. These eight cover most of a normal week — start here on Monday morning.

1 The three-line update

You owe someone a status and you're avoiding writing it.

You are helping me, a [YOUR ROLE] at [COMPANY], write a 3-line update to [WHO].
Situation: [WHAT HAPPENED – the one real fact].
Status now: [ON TRACK / DELAYED / BLOCKED, and by what].
Tone: calm, factual, no drama. No apology paragraph.
End with the single line: when I will next update them.

LEVEL UP Ask for a WhatsApp version and an email version of the same three lines.

2 Rewrite this so I can actually send it

You've written something, and it reads stiff, angry, or too long.

Here is a draft I wrote. Do not change the facts or soften my position.
Rewrite it to be: [under 120 words], [firm but warm], and readable in one glance.
Cut throat-clearing at the start. Keep every number, date and name exactly as written.
Then, below the rewrite, list in one line what you changed and why.

DRAFT:
[PASTE YOUR DRAFT]

LEVEL UP Ask for three versions on a scale from gentlest to firmest, then pick.

3 Rough notes into a clean email

You have half-sentences in a notebook and ten minutes before you leave.

Turn these rough notes into a clean email from me, [YOUR ROLE] at [COMPANY], to [READER].
Use ONLY what is in the notes. If something is missing, write [confirm] – never invent a detail.
Structure: one-line purpose, the facts, the ask, the deadline.
Tone: [professional and direct]. Under [150] words.

NOTES:
[PASTE MESSY NOTES]

4 Catch up on a thread you've ignored

Forty-message chain, and you're expected to reply today.

Read this email thread. Give me:
1. What was decided, in three bullets.
2. What is still open, and who owes what.
3. The one thing I am being asked for.
4. A short reply from me, [YOUR ROLE], that answers point 3 and nothing else.
Flag anything where two people appear to believe different things.

THREAD:
[PASTE THREAD]

5 Say no, politely and finally

A request you cannot accept — and a relationship you have to keep.

Write a short reply from me, [YOUR ROLE] at [COMPANY], declining this request: [REQUEST].
It must: thank them properly, give ONE honest reason, and be unambiguous — no "let me see" softening.
Then offer one alternative I can genuinely do: [ALTERNATIVE].
Warm, respectful, final. Under 100 words. No apology at the start.

LEVEL UP Then ask: "Write their likely pushback, and my reply to it."

6 The third chase

You've asked twice. You'd like an answer without burning the relationship.

I have chased [WHO] twice about [WHAT] with no reply. Write a third message.
Rules: do not scold, do not apologise for chasing, do not repeat the whole history.
Restate the ask in one line, state the consequence of continued silence factually
([the line stops / we re-plan the slot / I escalate to X]), and give a dated deadline: [DATE].
Under 80 words. Firm, not aggressive.

7 Make it WhatsApp-length

A long email nobody on the floor will read.

Compress this into a WhatsApp message for [WHO – shift group / supervisor / dealer].
Maximum [50] words. Plain language, no jargon, no greeting paragraph.
Lead with the thing they must act on. Put any number, time or PO on its own line.

LONG VERSION:
[PASTE]

8 The tone dial

The content is right, the temperature is wrong.

Take the message below and give me three versions, labelled:
A – Gentle (assumes goodwill), B – Neutral (pure facts), C – Firm (states consequences).
Same facts in all three. Do not add new information.
Then tell me in one line which you'd send to [a ten-year supplier / a brand-new customer], and why.

MESSAGE:
[PASTE]

High-stakes writing

Vendor negotiation, bad news, and the handover gap. These are the messages where tone decides whether a small problem stays small.

9 The late-supplier chaser

A PO has slipped past its date and your line is waiting.

You are a [procurement lead] at [COMPANY] writing to our [MATERIAL] supplier.
 Situation: [PO NUMBER] is delayed; [WHAT IT BLOCKS] needs it by [DATE].
 Write a short, firm-but-warm email that:

- names the PO and batch,
- asks for a revised dispatch window with a date,
- offers to accept a partial dispatch to keep the line running,
- asks for written confirmation by end of day.

Under 120 words. No threats. One clear ask.

10 Hold the price

A supplier wants a mid-contract increase you can't simply accept.

Our supplier has asked for a [7]% price increase mid-contract on [ITEM].
 Write my reply, in this exact order:

1. Acknowledge their cost pressure is real – briefly, genuinely.
2. Hold firm on the contracted price for the current term. Do not concede.
3. Offer ONE constructive trade: [staggered increase from (DATE) / longer term / higher volume commitment].

End with a specific proposal they can answer yes or no to.
 Professional, senior, no threats, under 180 words.

LEVEL UP The move that wins the meeting: ask it to write their most likely counter-reply, then draft your response to that.

11 Rehearse the whole negotiation

Before you send anything that matters.

Here is the message I plan to send: [PASTE].
 Act as the recipient – [THEIR ROLE AND INTEREST].

1. Write their most likely reply, honestly, including the objection I'd least like to hear.
2. Then write my response to that reply, holding my position: [POSITION].
3. Then list the two questions I should have an answer ready for before I hit send.

12 Bad news to a customer

The delay email. The golden rule lives here.

You are [YOUR ROLE] at [COMPANY] writing to [CUSTOMER], whose order [ORDER REF] will be [X] days late because [REASON].
 Write it in this order and no other: FACT (the new date, first line) → FIX (what we are doing) → OPTION (a partial dispatch / firm revised slot / my direct number) → one line of reassurance.
 Do NOT open with an apology. Do not use "we regret to inform".
 Under 150 words. Respect their time; give them something to act on.

LEVEL UP Lead with the fact and the fix — never the apology. It reads as competence, not indifference.

13 Same bad news, three tiers

One incident, three relationships worth different amounts of care.

Take the facts below and write three versions of the same notification:

- A – Key account: most proactive, offer of a personal call from me, named owner.
- B – Standard account: solid, clear, complete.
- C – Brand-new customer: extra reassurance, because they have no reason to trust us yet.

Same facts, different level of care. Do not invent commitments we haven't made.

FACTS: [PASTE]

14 Shift handover from messy notes

End of shift, everyone's tired, and reality has to survive the gap.

Turn these rough shift notes into a clean handover using EXACTLY these four headings:
LINE STATUS · ACTIONS TAKEN THIS SHIFT · WATCH-OUTS · PRIORITY FOR NEXT SHIFT.
Use only what is in my notes. If something is unknown, write "not reported" – never fill a gap with a guess.
Keep it scannable: short lines, no paragraphs.

NOTES:
[PASTE NOTES]

LEVEL UP Ask it to turn the output into a fixed reusable format — that's the start of an SOP for your line.

15 Escalate without drama

You need your HOD's attention, not their alarm.

Write a short escalation note from me to [HOD].
Issue: [WHAT]. Impact if unresolved: [COST / DELAY / RISK, with a number if I have one].
What I have already tried: [ACTIONS].
What I need from them, specifically: [DECISION / APPROVAL / A CALL TO X], by [DATE].
Neutral tone, no blame, no adjectives. Six lines maximum.
It must be readable in 20 seconds by someone in a meeting.

Finance & accounts

Use it beside Tally or SAP, never instead of them. The rule for every prompt here: cite the row, flag don't fix, and you sign off.

16 Ledger reconciliation

Invoices versus payments, and forty minutes of squinting you'd rather skip.

```
Below is a vendor ledger. Do the following and nothing more:
1. Total invoiced vs total paid, and the difference.
2. Every mismatch, cited BY ROW NUMBER.
3. Every suspected duplicate, cited by row number, with why you suspect it.
4. A three-line summary a manager could read in ten seconds.
RULES: use only the rows I give you. If a value looks like a typo, FLAG it – do not silently correct it.
No row number, no claim.

LEDGER:
[PASTE – use masked or synthetic data]
```

LEVEL UP Ask for it as a table with columns: Row | Issue | Amount | Action.

17 Duplicate payment hunt

The quiet leak nobody has time to look for.

```
Scan this payment register for possible duplicate payments.
Match on: same vendor + same amount within [7] days, similar invoice numbers,
and same amount paid against two different invoice references.
Output a table: Rows Involved | Vendor | Amount | Why Suspected | Confidence (high/med/low).
Do not conclude anything the data doesn't support. Say "insufficient data" where true.

DATA:
[PASTE]
```

18 Ageing summary + chaser list

Monday morning, and receivables need a plan not a spreadsheet.

```
From this receivables data, give me:
1. Buckets: 0-30, 31-60, 61-90, 90+ days – count and total value each.
2. The five accounts to chase first, ranked by [value at risk], with the reason for each.
3. For the top three, a one-line opening sentence I could use in the chaser.
Cite the source row for every figure.

DATA:
[PASTE]
```

19 The payment reminder ladder

One overdue account, four escalating touches, written once.

```
Write a four-step reminder sequence for an invoice [INVOICE REF] of [AMOUNT], now [45] days overdue with [CUSTOMER].
Step 1 (day 0): friendly assumption of an oversight.
Step 2 (day 7): factual, restates amount and due date.
Step 3 (day 14): firm, states the commercial consequence: [HOLD ON NEW ORDERS / CREDIT REVIEW].
Step 4 (day 21): final, before escalation, still professional.
Each under 90 words. Every one must name the amount, the invoice and a dated next step.
```

LEVEL UP This is the highest-value template in the book. Bracket the variables and file it once.

20 Explain the variance

A number moved and a non-finance manager needs to understand why.

```
Explain this variance to someone with no finance background, in plain English, in under 150 words.
Cover: what changed, by how much, the two or three likely drivers visible IN THIS DATA,
and what I should check next to confirm.
Do not speculate beyond the data. Mark any assumption clearly as [assumption].

DATA:
[PASTE]
```

21 Budget vs actual, told as a story

The monthly review pack, minus the dread.

```
From this budget-vs-actual data, write a management commentary:  
- The three biggest gaps by value, each with the % variance and the row reference.  
- One sentence per gap on the most plausible driver, marked [assumption] if it's inference.  
- One "watch this" item that isn't a problem yet but is trending badly.  
- A closing line stating what decision this month actually requires.  
Plain language. No jargon. No invented figures.
```

```
DATA:  
[PASTE]
```

22 Export to manager summary

A wall of exported rows at six in the evening.

```
Here is a raw export from [TALLY / SAP / our system]. It's messy.  
1. Tell me in one line what this data actually is.  
2. Give me the five things a [FINANCE HEAD] would want to know from it.  
3. Flag anything that looks wrong – blanks, outliers, impossible dates, currency oddities – by row.  
4. Write a 3-line summary I could paste into an email.  
Cite rows. Flag, don't fix.
```

```
EXPORT:  
[PASTE]
```

Operations & maintenance

The patterns are already sitting in your logs. Nobody has an afternoon spare to find them — so give the afternoon to the machine.

23 The month of breakdowns

Twenty lines of log that never get read.

```
Here is a month of breakdown entries: machine, date, issue, downtime.
Give me:
1. The top three recurring issue types, with counts.
2. The machine with the most total downtime, with the number.
3. One preventive action worth trialling next month, and why this data supports it.
Cite the figures you used for every conclusion. No guessing beyond the log.

LOG:
[PASTE]
```

24 Downtime × frequency

The small fault that quietly costs more than the dramatic one.

```
Rank the problems in this log by (total downtime × frequency), not by size alone –
a quick fault happening twenty times can cost more than one big failure.
Output a table: Rank | Issue | Occurrences | Total Downtime | Combined Impact.
Then write a one-line business case for the single fix worth doing first,
including the estimated minutes recovered per month based ONLY on these numbers.

LOG:
[PASTE]
```

25 SOP out of someone's head

The process that only [name] knows, and [name] is on leave.

```
I'm going to describe a routine I do, roughly, the way I'd explain it to a new colleague.
Turn it into a clean SOP with these headings: PURPOSE · WHO DOES THIS · MATERIALS &
TOOLS · STEPS (numbered, one action per line, each starting with a verb) · SAFETY CHECKS ·
DONE WHEN.
The DONE WHEN line is the important one: state how a person KNOWS they finished correctly,
in observable terms. If I haven't told you, write [confirm with (ROLE)].

MY DESCRIPTION:
[DESCRIBE IT MESSILY – that's fine]
```

LEVEL UP Anyone can list steps. "Done when" is what separates an SOP from a to-do list.

26 Did they actually learn it?

A nod is not competence.

```
From the SOP below, write a five-question competency check for a new operator.
Two questions on sequence, two on safety, one on how they'd know the job is done correctly.
Include the correct answer for each, drawn only from the SOP.
Then add one question a person could only answer if they had genuinely done the task.

SOP:
[PASTE]
```

27 Root cause, first pass

Before the blame meeting.

```
Act as an experienced [manufacturing quality] engineer.
Problem: [WHAT HAPPENED, with date, machine, and the observable symptom].
Run a structured 5-Whys, and where a step is uncertain, say so plainly.
Then give: the three most probable root causes ranked by likelihood, what evidence would
confirm or kill each one, and the single cheapest check I should run first.
Do not assert a cause the evidence doesn't support.
```

28 Complaint to CAPA

A customer complaint that has to become an action, not an argument.

```
Turn this customer complaint into a CAPA note with these fields:
COMPLAINT (factual, no adjectives) · IMMEDIATE CONTAINMENT · SUSPECTED CAUSE (marked
as suspected) · CORRECTIVE ACTION · PREVENTIVE ACTION · OWNER · TARGET DATE ·
HOW WE'LL VERIFY IT WORKED.
Leave [confirm] in any field I haven't given you information for. Invent nothing.

COMPLAINT:
[PASTE]
```

29 The morning huddle summary

Fifteen minutes of standing around, sharpened to one page.

```
From yesterday's production data below, write the summary for today's morning huddle:
1. Output vs plan, with the number.
2. The one thing that went wrong and its impact in minutes or units.
3. The one thing that went well, named, with credit to the line or shift.
4. Today's single priority, stated as an instruction.
Under 120 words. Read-aloud-able. No jargon.

DATA:
[PASTE]
```

Sales & customers

Sticking a name at the top is not personalisation. Putting the buyer's world into the message is. Give the AI that world.

30 One product, two buyers

The same profile pitched to people who want opposite things.

Our product: [PRODUCT, with 3 real specifics].
Write two short pitches, each leading with the ONE thing that buyer cares about most.
Buyer A – [e.g. an architect]: cares about [thermal performance, aesthetics, certifications].
Buyer B – [e.g. a volume builder]: cares about [lead time, price per unit, install speed].
The opening lines of A and B should barely overlap. Under 120 words each.
No "we are a leading manufacturer" opening in either.

LEVEL UP Add: "Handle the objection '[imported profiles are cheaper]' inside the pitch, before they raise it."

31 The cold first touch

The message to someone who has never heard of you.

Write a cold first-touch message to [ROLE] at [COMPANY TYPE], who has never heard from us.
Exactly four short lines:
1. Something relevant to THEIR business: [WHAT YOU KNOW ABOUT THEM].
2. One line on why [OUR COMPANY] specifically fits them.
3. One low-effort ask: [a sample / a 15-minute call].
4. A sign-off.
Banned: "I hope this email finds you well", "we are a leading manufacturer", any paragraph about us.

32 The follow-up sequence

So no warm lead ever dies because you got busy.

Build a three-message follow-up sequence for [LEAD] after [WHAT HAPPENED – sample sent / call had / quote shared].
Message 1 (day 0): the first touch.
Message 2 (day 4): a gentle nudge that adds ONE new piece of value, not just "checking in".
Message 3 (day 9): a final value-add with a clean exit – makes it easy to say no.
Each under 70 words. Never guilt them for not replying.

33 Pre-empt the objection

Answer it before it hardens in their head.

The objection I always get is: [OBJECTION].
1. Write the three strongest versions of that objection, as the customer would actually say it.
2. For each, write my honest 2-sentence response – no dismissing, no over-claiming.
3. Then write one line I can put in my pitch that defuses it before it's raised.
Where I'd need a real number to be convincing, mark it [insert your figure].

34 The quotation cover note

The thing they read before they look at the price.

Write the covering note for a quotation to [CUSTOMER] for [WHAT].
Three short paragraphs: what we understood their requirement to be (so they know we listened), what's included and explicitly what isn't, and the next step with a date: [VALIDITY / DECISION DATE].
Confident, plain, no filler. Do not restate the whole quote. Under 130 words.
Do not invent specifications, prices or lead times – leave [confirm] where I must fill in.

35 After the site visit

While they still remember you.

I visited [CUSTOMER] today. My rough notes: [PASTE NOTES].
Write a follow-up email that proves I listened: reference two specific things they said, confirm what I committed to and by when, and state one clear next step.
Then, separately, give me a 5-line internal CRM note: what they want, what's blocking them, who decides, budget signal, next action with a date.

36 Win / loss debrief

The order you lost is data, if you write it down.

From my notes on this [WON / LOST] deal, produce a debrief:

1. The decisive factor, in one sentence.
 2. Three things that helped and three that hurt.
 3. What a competitor did better, if visible in the notes.
 4. One change to our approach for the next deal like this.
- Be blunt. Do not flatter me. Mark anything you're inferring as [inference].

NOTES:

[PASTE]

HR & people

The rule that matters most in this section: an honest gap is useful, a confident fabrication in a policy is dangerous.

37 Technical JD without the week of chasing

You need the wording right, and engineering is busy.

Draft a job description for a [ROLE, e.g. Extrusion Line Technician] at [COMPANY], a [INDUSTRY] business. Include: role purpose (2 lines), 5-7 key responsibilities, must-have skills, nice-to-haves, who they report to, and shift pattern. CRITICAL: do not invent certifications, statutory requirements, salary or experience thresholds. Where you're unsure, write [confirm with plant lead] in brackets. An honest gap is useful; a made-up requirement is dangerous.

LEVEL UP Then ask: "List every line in this JD you were not certain about." It will tell you.

38 Interview kit

So three interviewers judge the same thing.

For the role below, write:

1. Six interview questions – three technical, two behavioural, one on safety judgement.
2. For each, a two-line description of what a STRONG answer sounds like and what a WEAK one sounds like.
3. One practical task we could set in 15 minutes to see the skill rather than hear about it.

Questions must be legal, non-discriminatory, and answerable by someone from a [shop-floor] background.

ROLE:
[PASTE JD]

39 Policy in plain language

A clause people will actually follow because they understood it.

Rewrite this policy clause at a Grade-8 reading level, keeping every obligation and entitlement exactly intact – do not soften, drop or add any rule. Then: flag any sentence that could reasonably be read two different ways, and offer a fixed version. Finally, write the same clause as three FAQ-style questions an employee would actually ask.

CLAUSE:
[PASTE]

40 Offer and rejection notes

Both say a lot about the company.

Write two messages for [ROLE]:

A – Offer note: warm, specific about why we chose them ([REASON]), clear on next step and date.

B – Rejection note: short, respectful, no false hope, no "we'll keep your CV on file" unless we will. Give one genuine, non-generic sentence of feedback in B based on: [REASON THEY WEREN'T SELECTED]. Never state or imply any protected characteristic as a reason.

41 Day 1 to Day 30

New joiner, and nobody's written down what happens.

Build a 30-day induction plan for a [ROLE] joining [DEPARTMENT]. Structure it as Week 1 / Week 2 / Weeks 3-4, and for each: what they learn, who they shadow, what they should be able to do UNAIDED by the end of it, and one checkpoint conversation. Include safety and systems access in Week 1. Mark anything company-specific I must fill as [confirm].

42 Feedback that's specific, not vague

"Be more proactive" has never improved anyone.

Help me give feedback to [PERSON, ROLE]. What I observed: [SPECIFIC BEHAVIOUR, with an example and a date]. Impact it had: [IMPACT]. Write it using: observation → impact → the specific change I'm asking for → the support I'll give. No character judgements, no "you always", no sandwich. One paragraph. Then give me the two questions I should ask them before I assume I understand why it happened.

43 Training needs from a survey

Free-text answers nobody has read.

Below are free-text survey responses from [N] people.

1. Group them into themes, with the count in each.
 2. Quote two short representative lines per theme (verbatim, no paraphrasing).
 3. Identify the three needs that appear across multiple departments.
 4. Recommend one intervention per theme, sized as: quick fix / one session / real programme.
- Do not invent sentiment that isn't in the text.

RESPONSES:

[PASTE]

Your own week

The last seven are about your time and your judgement — including the two prompts that build the rest of your library for you.

44 Meeting notes → decisions

An hour of talking, and nobody's sure what was agreed.

Turn these meeting notes into a record with exactly three sections:
 DECISIONS MADE · ACTIONS (Owner | Action | Date) · OPEN QUESTIONS (and who must answer).
 Anything discussed but not decided goes in OPEN QUESTIONS — do not promote it to a decision.
 If an action has no owner or no date in my notes, write [owner?] or [date?]. Never assign one yourself.

NOTES:
 [PASTE]

45 An agenda that ends on time

Before you send the invite.

Design an agenda for a [30]-minute meeting on [TOPIC] with [WHO ATTENDS].
 For each item: minutes allocated, the decision or output required, and who leads it.
 Put the item that MUST be decided first, not last.
 Add one line at the top stating the meeting's purpose in the form "By the end we will have decided ____".
 If the agenda can't fit the time, tell me what to cut.

46 The Monday triage

Everything feels urgent at 9am.

Here is everything on my plate this week: [LIST IT ROUGHLY].
 My role: [ROLE]. My one non-negotiable this week: [THE THING].
 Sort it into: DO TODAY · SCHEDULE (with a suggested day) · DELEGATE (to whom, and the one-line brief I'd send) · DROP OR DEFER (say plainly why).
 Then tell me the single item most likely to blow up if I ignore it, and why.

47 Explain it like I'm new

The acronym everyone uses that you've never asked about.

Explain [TOPIC / TERM / DOCUMENT] to me as if I'm competent but completely new to it.
 Give me: what it is in one sentence, why anyone cares, the three things I actually need to remember, one analogy from everyday life, and the two mistakes beginners make.
 No jargon unless you define it in the same line. Then ask me two questions to check I've got it.

48 Argue against me

Before you take the plan to your HOD.

Here is my plan: [PASTE].
 Act as a sharp, fair-minded sceptic who wants this to succeed.
 1. The three strongest arguments AGAINST it.
 2. The assumption it depends on that I haven't examined.
 3. What would have to be true for this to fail badly.
 4. The single cheapest test that would tell me early whether I'm wrong.
 Be direct. Do not flatter the plan.

49 Prompt → reusable template

The move that turns your win into your team's win.

Here is a prompt that worked well for me: [PASTE PROMPT].
 Convert it into a reusable template:
 1. Identify every part that would CHANGE each time and replace it with a [BRACKETED_SLOT].
 2. Keep the instructions, tone and structure locked — those are the quality.
 3. Add 1-2 guardrails, e.g. "never invent a date; if it's missing, ask me".
 4. Give it a short findable name and a one-line "use this when ____".
 5. Show one filled-in example using invented, non-confidential values.

LEVEL UP Variables you fill, structure you keep. That's the whole difference between a prompt and an asset.

50 Audit my prompt

When the answer disappointed you and you don't know why.

```
Here's a prompt I wrote: [PASTE].  
Score it out of 5 on each of Context, Tone, Persona and Format, and say which is weakest.  
Rewrite it to fix the weakest two – WITHOUT making it longer. Precision is fewer words aimed better.  
Then list the three specific details only I could supply that would most improve the output,  
and ask me for them.
```

Ten follow-ups that fix almost anything

A disappointing first answer is normal and it is not your fault. Don't rewrite the whole prompt — say one of these and run it again.

1. "Shorter. Cut a third."

The fastest quality upgrade there is.

2. "Add one concrete detail — a name, a date, a number."

Fixes almost every "too generic" output.

3. "Say that again for someone who's tired and in a hurry."

Plain-language mode.

4. "What did you assume that I didn't tell you?"

Surfaces the invented bits.

5. "Give me three versions: gentlest, neutral, firmest."

Lets you choose instead of argue.

6. "Match the style of this — [paste an example]."

Examples beat adjectives, every time.

7. "Where might you be wrong about this?"

Cheap insurance before you send.

8. "Cite the row / the source for every claim."

No row number, no claim.

9. "Flag it, don't fix it."

Stops it hiding your errors under a smile.

10. "Now turn this into a template with bracketed blanks."

Turns today's win into next month's asset.

REMEMBER

**Precision is not more words.
It's fewer words, aimed better.**

Lines to paste into any prompt

A guardrail is one sentence telling the AI what *not* to do. It's what makes a template safe enough to hand to a colleague who'll run it unsupervised. Add one or two to anything that touches numbers, policy or customers.

Use only the information I have given you. If something is missing, write **[confirm]** – do not invent it.

Cite the row number or source line for every figure you state.

If a value looks like a typo, flag it. Do not silently correct it.

Never invent a date, a price, a certification or a commitment.

If you are less than confident about a statement, mark it **[assumption]**.

Ask me for anything you need rather than guessing it.

Do not add facts that are not in my notes, even if they would improve the message.

Stay under **[N]** words. If you cannot, tell me what you have to leave out.

WHY THIS MATTERS A tool that's too eager to help can hide your errors under a smile. It will quietly "correct" a number instead of telling you it looked wrong. "Flag it, don't fix it" keeps you in control of what's true.

Add your own

The best prompt in your department hasn't been written yet — you'll write it in about three weeks, on a Tuesday, when something annoys you enough. When you do, capture it in this shape and send it to your library steward. A template nobody can find isn't an asset, it's a buried file.

TEMPLATE NAME:

DEPARTMENT: [Finance / Sales / Operations / HR / Engineering]

WHAT IT DOES: (one line)

WHEN TO USE IT: (one line)

THE PROMPT: (full prompt, with [BRACKETED_SLOTS])

GUARDRAILS: (1-2 lines, e.g. "never invent a date; ask me instead")

WORKED EXAMPLE: (one filled-in run, synthetic values only)

AUTHOR / DATE:

REUSE RATING: ___ / 5

THIRTY DAYS FROM TODAY

If you don't use a skill for thirty days, it evaporates. You're not leaving with inspiration — inspiration fades by the car park. You're leaving with a plan. Keep it small enough that a busy week can't kill it.

1 Weekly habit	From Monday, every week I will use AI to ..
2 Template I'll share	I'll give my "" template by
3 Person I'll teach	I'll show how to by
4 How I'll know it worked	I'll track and review it on

Generate a library like this one

This is the prompt that produced the fifty you've just read. Fill the brackets with your own department, run it, then edit hard — you know your work better than any model does. This is the most useful page in the book: it makes the other pages reproducible.

```
You are an expert prompt engineer and a corporate learning designer.
Build me a complete, ready-to-publish PROMPT LIBRARY for the people who attended a one-day
GenAI workshop, so they can keep using what they learned on Monday morning.

THE AUDIENCE
- Company: [COMPANY NAME] · Industry: [INDUSTRY] · Location: [CITY]
- Functions in the room: [e.g. Finance, Operations & Maintenance, Sales, HR, Engineering]
- Skill level: mostly non-technical. Comfortable with [Tally / SAP / Excel], new to AI.
- The tools they have: [company-issued AI account]

WHAT TO PRODUCE
[50] prompts, grouped into [7] sections of roughly equal size, one section per function
plus one on everyday writing and one on personal productivity.

FORMAT – every single prompt must have exactly these four parts:
1. TITLE – short, plain, memorable (max 6 words).
2. USE WHEN – one line describing the real moment this is for.
3. THE PROMPT – a full, copy-paste-ready prompt using [BRACKETED_SLOTS] for anything the
  user must supply. It must include Context, Tone, Persona and Format, and at least one
  guardrail (e.g. "use only what I give you; write [confirm] rather than inventing").
4. LEVEL UP – one optional follow-up instruction that makes the output notably better.

RULES
- Every prompt must be about real work at [COMPANY], using its actual vocabulary:
  [list 8-10 real terms – products, systems, roles, documents].
- No toy examples, no "write a poem", nothing anyone would call a gimmick.
- Prompts should be 4-10 lines. Precision is fewer words aimed better, not more words.
- Never assume confidential data will be pasted: every data prompt must say masked or synthetic data.
- Vary the verbs: draft, rewrite, summarise, compare, extract, rank, critique, interrogate, template.
- No two prompts should solve the same problem.

ALSO INCLUDE
- A one-page "how to use this" opener built on Context · Tone · Persona · Format.
- Ten universal follow-up lines that rescue a disappointing answer.
- A page of copy-paste guardrail sentences.
- A blank template card so people can add their own prompts.
- A four-line 30-day plan page.

OUTPUT
Return it as clean structured text I can paste into a document, with clear section headers
and every prompt in a fenced block. Do not summarise or abbreviate – write all [50] in full.
Start by asking me for anything above that I left blank.
```

NOTE The last line matters. Telling it to ask you for missing details first is what stops it inventing a version of your company.

ONE LAST THING

You didn't learn about AI. You used it.

Pick one prompt. Use it on Monday. Teach it to one person by Friday.
That's how a training day turns into a habit — and a habit into an advantage.